SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT (SWMS)

DOCUMENT CONTROL	
SWMS_ID	SWMS-027
SWMS_Title	Working on Energised or Unguarded Plant
SWMS_Version	1.0
SWMS_Type	☒ Core SWMS ☐ Routine Task SWMS ☐ Non-Routine Task SWMS
Status	☐ Draft ☐ Current ☐ Superseded
Authorised_By	Chris Foster
Authorised_Date	25/06/2026
Review_Date	25/07/2027
Review_Period_Months	12
Review_Trigger	☒ Initial Issue ☐ Incident ☐ Legislative Change ☐ Procedure Change ☐ Equipment Change ☐ Risk Assessment Review ☐ Scheduled Review

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Change Summary	Authorised By
1.0	25/06/2026	Initial Issue	Chris Foster

SWMS ID: SWMS-027	**SWMS Title:** Working on Energised or Unguarded Plant
Prepared By: Chris Foster	**Date:** 24/06/2026

Business Name: Tuan Biomass Albioma

Description of Task:

- Testing or commissioning plant with guards in place (operational trial / function test)
- Inspecting, adjusting, or observing running plant with guards temporarily removed (fault-finding, sensor check, visual inspection)
- Clearing blockages or material build-up using plant motion (nudge/inch operation, reverse-run)
- Lubrication, minor adjustment, or measurement on running plant where isolation is not practicable
- Running-in checks or sequential-start tests following maintenance (plant energised, guards not fully refitted)

Reason for analysis: ☐ New task/plant ☒ High Risk Task ☐ Change ☐ Regular review ☐ Post-Incident ☐ Contractor (to complete) Task ☐ Non-Routine Task ☐ Maintenance/Repair ☐

Other *(specify)*:

SWMS Team Names: 1. Chris Foster	2. David Knight	3.
4.	5.	6.

Permits Required: *(circle)*

Confined Space ☐ Isolation ☐

Hot Work ☐

PPE Requirements:

Other:

Potential Environment Hazards	Fire/Emergency Response Equipment
☐ Noise / vibration ☐ Air pollution – dust / smoke / fume ☐ Spills to ground ☐ Spills to water / drains / waterways ☐ Soil erosion / contamination ☐ Hazards to flora & fauna ☐ Waste generation & disposal ☐ Hazardous chemicals / substances ☐ Vegetation / bushfire risk ☐ Other: ______________________	☒ **Fire extinguisher — Location:** Main shed wall ☒ **Fire hose / hydrant — Location:** Walking Floor, Shavings silo, inside shed ☒ **First aid kit — Location:** Smoko Room ☒ **Spill kit — Location:** Inside the North Entry door ☒ **Emergency eyewash / shower — Location:** Outside the workshop ☒ **Emergency assembly point — Location:** ☒ **Communication method:** ☐ Radio ☐ Phone ☐ Verbal ☒ **Emergency contact No:** 0439 013 224

Hazards Identified
☒ Electricity ☐ Confined Space ☒ Stored Energy ☐ Extreme Temperatures ☒ Dust and or fume ☐ Hazardous Manual Tasks ☐ Psychological ☐ Traffic/Mobile Plant ☐ Ignition Sources ☐ Lighting ☒ Machinery & Equipment ☐ Person/Object Falling ☐ Pressure (air, water, gas) ☐ Object Falling ☐ Hazardous Chemicals ☐ Hot Work ☐ Other workers/people
Other Comments:

REQUIRED CORE SWMS

List the Core SWMS that also apply to this task. Linked Core SWMS must be read and signed on through the online SWMS Register together with this SWMS.

Applies	Core SWMS	Linked SWMS_ID
☒	Isolation and LOTO	SWMS-026
☐	Hot Work	SWMS-005
☐	Confined Space Entry	SWMS-024
☐	Working at Heights	SWMS-025
☐	Crane and Lifting Operations	SWMS-026
☐	Working on Energised or Unguarded Plant	SWMS-027

CRITICAL CONTROLS

The following critical controls must be in place and verified before work starts.

#	Critical Control (must be in place before work starts)
1	A second person (spotter/standby) is present for all tasks on energised or unguarded plant. The standby person must not be engaged in the task — they remain positioned to observe, communicate, and call for emergency response.
2	All personnel involved have read and signed onto this SWMS via the online SWMS Register. No person may commence work without a current sign-on.
3	An Energised Plant Authority or equivalent written authority has been issued and is in possession of the person in control of the task, with the scope, plant, and duration clearly defined.
4	Exclusion zones are established and barricaded around all exposed nip points, rotating components, in-running parts, and pinch points. No unauthorised persons are within the exclusion zone.
5	All plant in the exclusion zone that is not required for the task is isolated and locked out (SWMS-026). Only the minimum plant necessary to complete the task is energised.
6	Emergency stop (E-stop) locations are confirmed and accessible. The standby person knows the location of all relevant E-stops, emergency contacts, and evacuation procedures.
7	Task-specific communication method is agreed (radio channel, hand signals, verbal) and tested before plant is energised. No task relying solely on verbal communication shall proceed if background noise renders this unreliable.
8	Guards removed for inspection or testing are tagged with a guard-removal tag, logged on the Task Record, and a guard-replacement step is included in the task plan before plant is returned to service.

If a critical control cannot be implemented, work must stop and the SWMS must be reviewed before proceeding.

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT (SWMS)

Key Steps in Logical Order		Hazards/Risks to Workers or Public	Risk Score	Control Measures	Residual Risk Score
1	Pre-task authorisation and planning	• Unauthorised or unplanned work on energised plant • Inadequate hazard identification • Inadequate personnel competency	High	• Obtain Energised Plant Authority before commencing. Define scope, plant ID, duration, and personnel. • Review this SWMS and all required Core SWMS (especially SWMS-026 Isolation & LOTO). • Confirm all persons involved hold the required competencies and have signed onto this SWMS. • Conduct pre-task toolbox talk — confirm hazards, controls, communication method, and E-stop locations. • Notify the Control Room / Plant Manager that energised plant work is commencing.	Low
2	Establishing exclusion zones and barricading	• Unauthorised person entering exclusion zone • Inadequate barricading — person contacts moving plant • Unexpected plant start-up during zone setup	High	• Identify all nip points, in-running parts, rotating shafts, and pinch points before barricading. • Use physical barriers (safety mesh, barrier tape + stanchions) — tape alone is not sufficient for areas with significant risk. • Place exclusion zone signage: 'DANGER — Energised Plant — Authorised Persons Only'. • Isolate any plant NOT required for the task before entering the exclusion zone (SWMS-026). • Standby person to maintain zone integrity — no task activities while zone is unmonitored. • Confirm with Control Room that plant will not be commanded remotely while zone is active.	High
3	Guard removal for inspection, testing, or fault-finding	• Contact with rotating/moving parts — entanglement, crush, amputation • Object ejection from unguarded aperture • Failure to reinstate guards before return to service	High	• Isolation — plant MUST be isolated (SWMS-026) before guards are physically removed. • Attach a guard-removal tag to the open guard location immediately on removal. • Do not reach across or into any aperture even with plant isolated. Use tools or probes. • When plant is re-energised for test/inspection with guards removed: maintain minimum safe distance (≥ 1 m from rotating parts unless a specific safe observation point is approved). • Never use hands to guide, steady, or slow moving components — use appropriate tools only. • Reinstate and secure all guards before returning plant to normal operation. Verify before pre-start.	High
4	Testing or commissioning with guards fitted	• Unexpected start-up injuring personnel in proximity • Guard failure / ejection under load • Communication failure between operator and observers	High	• Confirm all guards are correctly fitted and fastened before energising plant. • Clear all personnel from inside the exclusion zone. Zone must be verified clear before start command. • Agree start signal — operator announces 'Starting [plant name] in 3 seconds' via radio or verbal. Observers confirm ready. • Initial start should be brief (momentary jog/inch) — observe for abnormal noise, vibration, or movement before running continuously. • Observers must remain outside the exclusion zone for the first run. Entry only after plant has been stopped and stabilised.	Med

5	Clearing blockages or material build-up using plant motion (Bumping)	• Hand / arm drawn into conveyor, auger, or chute while attempting to clear blockage • Sudden surge of material causing injury • Plant restarting unexpectedly mid-clearing activity • Working in proximity to energised plant — crush, entanglement	**High**	• PREFERRED METHOD: Isolate plant (SWMS-026), clear blockage manually using tools (poles, rods, scrapers). Only use plant motion to clear blockage if isolation is not practicable • If Bumping is required: one person operates controls, one person observes — never operate controls AND observe simultaneously. • Operator must have line of sight to the blockage area OR communication with observer at all times during bump. • NEVER place any body part into a chute, conveyor, or machine to assist clearing while plant is energised. • Use clearing tools (push rods, hooks, probes) of adequate length to keep hands clear of all nip points. • bump only — single short pulses. Do not run plant continuously until blockage is confirmed cleared. • After clearing: stop plant, apply isolation (SWMS-026), inspect cleared area before returning to service. • If blockage cannot be cleared safely with above controls, stop and escalate to Plant Manager.	**High**
6	Running maintenance — lubrication, adjustment, or measurement on energised plant	• Contact with rotating parts during lubrication • Loose clothing / PPE caught in moving parts • Chemical exposure — lubricants, greases • Inhalation of dust, vapour, or aerosol from running plant	**High**	• Confirm task cannot be performed with plant isolated. If isolation is practicable, isolate (SWMS-026). • Wear close-fitting clothing with no loose ends, cuffs, or drawstrings. Remove all jewellery. Secure long hair. • Use purpose-designed long-reach lubrication tools (extended grease fittings, flexible lines) — do not reach across rotating parts. • Standby person required — positioned to observe and call E-stop if required. • Use SDS-compliant PPE for lubricants being applied. Avoid skin contact. • Use appropriate respiratory protection if running plant generates dust or aerosol. • Maintain awareness of pinch points and in-running nips at all times — do not become distracted.	**High**
7	Running-in or sequential-start tests following maintenance	• Plant fault or failure during first run causing ejection, rupture, or uncontrolled movement • Guards not fully reinstated before test • Personnel in vicinity of plant during test	**High**	• Complete pre-start inspection checklist before energising. Verify: all guards fitted, all tools removed, all workers accounted for and outside exclusion zone. • Check all fasteners, connections, and couplings are reinstated and torqued to specification. • Notify Control Room / Plant Manager before commencing sequential start. Log start time. • First run: momentary bump only. Stop and inspect before extending run duration. • Observer to remain outside exclusion zone during initial starts — entry for close inspection only after plant has been running stably and is stopped. • Log all observations, anomalies, and corrective actions in the plant diary.	**High**

Add additional job steps, hazards and controls as required

All relevant workers must be consulted during the development and review of this SWMS and made aware of the control measures and all required permits. Worker consultation and sign-on are recorded through the online SWMS Register.

ONLINE SWMS MANAGEMENT

Worker sign-on is completed through the online SWMS Register.

Workers are required to read and sign onto this SWMS once per review period, or sooner if the SWMS is revised, superseded, or changed due to an incident, equipment change, procedure change, legislative change, or risk assessment review.

Before each task commences, the team or person in control of the work must review the SWMS through the online task review system and confirm whether anything has changed from the approved SWMS.

If no changes are identified, the task may proceed once all workers are confirmed as current against the required SWMS.

If changes are identified, the changes and additional controls must be recorded in the online Task Record before work proceeds. Supervisor review is required where the change affects the work method, plant, equipment, location, hazards, permit requirements, or critical controls.

System of record

This Word document is the controlled master SWMS. The PDF is the worker-view copy. The HTML tablet page is used to view the SWMS and complete the task review.

Worker sign-off is stored in Worker_SWMS_Register. Daily task reviews are stored in Task_Records. Review dates and version status are controlled in SWMS_Library.

AUTHORISATION		
Approved by: Chris Foster	**Position:** Safety and Compliance Manager	**Approval Date:** 25/06/2026